



2026 AZERBAIJAN GRAND PRIX

24 - 26 September 2026

From	The Stewards	Document	68
To	The Team Manager, Audi Revolut F1 Team	Date	26 September 2026
		Time	19:52

The Stewards, having received a report from the Race Director, summoned (document 60) and heard from the driver and team representative, have considered the following matter and determine the following:

No / Driver 5 - Gabriel Bortoleto

Competitor Audi Revolut F1 Team

Time 16:12

Session Race

Fact Overtaking under yellow flags

Infringement Breach of Appendix H, Article 2.5.5 b) of the International Sporting Code

Decision 10 second time penalty.

Reason Reason: The Stewards heard from the driver of Car 5 (Gabriel Bortoleto), team representative and reviewed video and in-car video evidence.

The incident occurred between Turns 6 and 7 during the first lap after the restart of the race. At the relevant time, marshal posts in this area were displaying physical "SC" boards together with waved Yellow Flags. However, the Stewards established that, at that time, the Safety Car had not in fact been deployed by Race Control.

BOR explained that he initially reacted to the SC boards and Yellow Flags. However, he did not see any corresponding electronic indication and did not receive a Safety Car indication on his steering wheel. He was also informed by his Team that the Safety Car had not been deployed. BOR therefore became uncertain as to the actual status of the Race and, not wishing to lose position unnecessarily, subsequently overtook PER.

The Stewards accept that the conflicting information contributed significantly to the situation. In particular, as the Safety Car had not been deployed, BOR cannot be considered to have overtaken another car under Safety Car conditions.

However, this does not dispose of the separate issue of the waved Yellow Flags. BOR confirmed that he had seen the Yellow Flags but explained that, because they were displayed together with the SC boards, he understood them to be part of the same Safety Car indication and therefore considered that they were no longer relevant once he had been informed that the Safety Car had not been deployed.

The Stewards do not accept this interpretation. A waved Yellow Flag is an instruction in its own right and must be respected irrespective of any accompanying signal. A driver cannot disregard a Yellow Flag based on his own assessment as to why it has been displayed or whether it should have been displayed. The 2026 FIA practice likewise treats Yellow Flag indications as requiring compliance even where

surrounding circumstances are unusual.

Accordingly, notwithstanding the understandable confusion concerning the SC boards, BOR had seen the waved Yellow Flags and nevertheless overtook PER while the Yellow Flag condition remained in effect. The Stewards therefore determine that BOR overtook another car under Yellow Flag conditions.

The Stewards acknowledge that the erroneous SC indications and the conflicting information contributed to the circumstances of the incident. However, these circumstances do not remove the obligation to respect a waved Yellow Flag and the Stewards therefore apply the standard penalty for overtaking under a Single Yellow Flag.

Competitors are reminded that they have the right to appeal certain decisions of the Stewards, in accordance with Article 15 of the FIA International Sporting Code and Chapter 5 of the FIA Judicial and Disciplinary Rules, within the applicable time limits.

Decisions of the Stewards are taken independently of the FIA and are based solely on the relevant regulations, guidelines and evidence presented.

Gerd Ennser

Loïc Bacquelaine

Khatuna Julakidze

Derek Warwick

Danil Solomin

The Stewards